

About Evidence Correlation Standard - (ECS)

Understanding Evidence Correlation Standard

What Is Evidence Correlation Standard?

Evidence Correlation Standard is the fourth Parent Standard of ADIT® — Continuous Audit & Evidence Governance Architecture™. It governs how independently governed evidence is connected, contextualized, sequenced, and related to reconstruct operational reality while preserving the integrity of every individual evidence object.

Evidence Correlation Standard recognizes that trustworthy evidence alone is often insufficient to explain what actually happened. Operational understanding emerges when multiple evidence objects are accurately connected through governed relationships, chronology, dependencies, context, and causality.

Canonical Definition

Evidence Correlation Standard defines the governance conditions required to establish, validate, manage, and preserve relationships between multiple governed evidence objects. It establishes evidence correlation principles, relationship rules, dependency validation, contextual linkage, correlation governance, and continuous correlation assurance necessary to reconstruct operational reality from trustworthy evidence throughout the complete lifecycle of a governed entity.

Why Evidence Correlation Standard Exists

Operational events rarely produce only one piece of evidence.

Organizations must combine logs, documents, decisions, transactions, identities, communications, and system records into a coherent representation of operational reality. Without governed correlation, evidence remains fragmented and important relationships may be overlooked or misunderstood.

Evidence Correlation Standard exists to ensure that trustworthy evidence can be accurately connected without compromising its integrity.

What Evidence Correlation Standard Governs

Evidence Correlation Standard governs:

- Evidence relationships
 - Evidence linkage
 - Contextual association
 - Chronological correlation
 - Dependency mapping
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- Causal relationships
 - Evidence network integrity
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Use Case 1 — Autonomous AI Governance

Scenario

An autonomous AI ecosystem generates evidence across multiple agents, services, and operational environments.

Application

Evidence Correlation Standard governs how all evidence objects are linked through governed relationships, timelines, operational dependencies, and contextual associations to reconstruct the complete operational sequence.

Result

Organizations obtain a complete, trustworthy, and explainable representation of autonomous system behavior.

Use Case 2 — Digital Forensics

Scenario

A cybersecurity investigation requires analysts to reconstruct a complex attack involving multiple systems and evidence sources.

Application

Evidence Correlation Standard governs how logs, user activities, network events, access records, and system evidence are accurately correlated into a single governed operational timeline.

Result

Investigators reconstruct the complete incident using objectively governed evidence relationships suitable for audit, legal review, and regulatory investigation.

Architectural Position

Evidence Correlation Standard represents the fourth governed space within ADIT® — Continuous Audit & Evidence Governance Architecture™, transforming independently trustworthy evidence into a coherent operational representation before evidence verification and audit execution begin.

Governance Flow

Audit Observation → Evidence Formation → Evidence Integrity → Evidence Correlation → Evidence Verification → Audit Execution → Audit Findings → Audit

Canonical Closing Statement

Evidence Correlation Standard establishes the canonical governance framework for connecting independently governed evidence into coherent representations of operational reality. By governing evidence relationships, contextual linkage, dependency mapping, chronological sequencing, and continuous correlation assurance, Evidence Correlation Standard enables reliable audit, operational reconstruction, accountable governance, and independent verification across all operational domains.

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Canonical Source

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